

transitioned to become a directed fund under the Linux Foundation. Today, it operates as one of many projects within the Linux Foundation.

Q. How big is this community?
A. It's hard to tell, but there are a little over 20,000 people on our Slack.

Q. What role do these partnerships and collaborations play in Cloud Foundry's initiative?

A. The members of the Cloud Foundry Foundation provide essential funding to keep the foundation running. Membership fees from these companies support the foundation's activities, and members contribute in various ways. They nominate representatives to the governing board, participate in the Technical Oversight Committee (TOC), and supply staffing for many projects. They also help fund our events and identify key industry events for us to attend or sponsor.

For instance, at KubeCons around the world, our members assist with staffing support. Indirectly, this participation also serves as a signal of their investment in the project and its active development when they present it to their major clients. This symbiotic relationship is essential for sustaining the project, the foundation, and the community. Our membership ranges from major corporations to smaller companies.

Q. How is the democratic ethos and open source spirit of the foundation maintained with such big companies being members?

A. This is where the Linux Foundation, or the vendor-neutral history of the Cloud Foundry Foundation, plays a prominent role. The foundation operates independently of any vendor influence, prioritising the interests of the open source project above all. We carefully avoid

any involvement with vendors' commercial activities.

Q. What are the benefits this foundation provides to developers? Why should developers be a part of it?

A. Being part of the Cloud Foundry community grants direct access to maintainers, contributors, and members of the governing board or TOC. This setup effectively removes any hierarchy or layers between a developer looking to achieve something within Cloud Foundry and those who can make it happen.

The community is small enough that every developer can have a voice and make an impact, yet large enough to encompass a wide range of individuals working across various open source projects. Ultimately, if a developer seeks an impactful, community-driven open source experience, Cloud Foundry offers a strong foundation to start with.

Q. What projects is the foundation working on?

A. Active development is a key focus of the foundation, with Cloud Foundry at the core—a comprehensive suite of projects rather than a single starting point. One central component is BOSH, or the BOSH Director, which plays a crucial role in managing and deploying infrastructure within Cloud Foundry. The ecosystem also includes various smaller projects essential to its functionality, such as UAA for authentication, and other components dedicated to logging, security, and networking. These individual projects can be utilised independently, but together they form the complete Cloud Foundry installation essential for foundational operations within the platform.

Additionally, there are projects that overlap with other communities. For example, our projects Korifi and Paketo are used heavily by

folks in the Kubernetes and Cloud Native communities. These projects are built and maintained to serve users who belong to a community adjacent to ours.

Q. How would you describe the expanse and use of Cloud Foundry geographically?

A. Cloud Foundry is used worldwide, though the exact scale is difficult to pinpoint. There's a strong presence in North America, a large contingent in Europe, and a substantial community in Bengaluru, as is common with many major technologies.

In India, the State Bank of India leverages Cloud Foundry, while in the UK, the government also relies on it. Governments in Canada, the US (through *cloud.gov*, a Cloud Foundry-powered PaaS for federal agencies), and South Korea are users. Alongside these governmental applications, many financial institutions and large corporations, like Mercedes-Benz in the EU, are also part of the Cloud Foundry ecosystem.

Q. How do you manage and govern all these contributions?

A. The Cloud Foundry community is organised into working groups led by elected working group leads. These groups report to a Technical Oversight Committee (TOC), which collaborates with the working groups and their leads. Above the TOC is a governing board that provides overall direction.

My team and I provide various services for these groups, such as setting up GitHub accounts, creating AWS and GCP-based pipelines for testing, and ensuring that all required resources are functional. Each working group operates as a self-governing unit within its project, while our role primarily involves support. We also contribute by promoting the open source tool and handling related marketing activities.